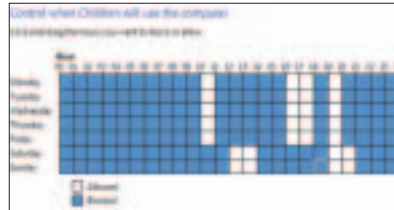


office suite software to do so. Windows Calendar effectively removes the need for this, providing many of the same features (appointments, calendar sharing and the like) as the full version of Microsoft Outlook 2007. As with many of Vista's features, Windows Calendar is curiously understated, but it could be the very tool you've been looking for to help keep you organised.



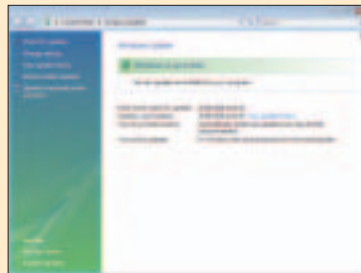
HTo prevent children from hogging the computer, it is possible to place time restrictions on its usage

Read all about it

Some of Vista's new features are so small, they can at first seem insignificant, but can in fact have a major impact on your day-to-day computer use. Internet Explorer's RSS capabilities are a good example. The ever-increasing popularity of the internet has led to

Windows Ultimate Extras

Anyone with Vista Ultimate installed has access to even more tools and utilities, including additional backup facilities, better security and a direct pipeline to further useful features via Windows Ultimate Extras. Downloadable through Windows Update, Ultimate Extras are exclusive features that can be added for free. Extras currently available include Dreamscene, which allows video files to be used as a desktop background; Bitlocker Drive Preparation Tool, which can be used to automate preparing a partition for encryption; and card game Hold 'Em Poker. Ultimate Extras has been the subject of derision due to the small number of tools released, but this is set to change. One still in the pipeline is Group Shot, a photo-editing tool that can be used to create a perfect photograph by picking the best bits out of a series of shots. There's currently no release date, but it is certainly one to look out for.



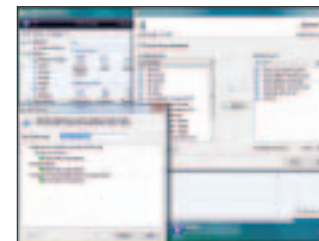
Windows Ultimate Extras are automatically delivered via Vista's Windows Update feature

the creation of a huge number of websites dedicated to various types of news. Whether you're interested in current affairs, celebrity news or sport, there is a website that can provide you with the latest headlines. However, it's unlikely that you'll be interested in just a single topic, and keeping abreast of the latest developments could mean visiting a very large number of sites. This is where RSS feeds come in.

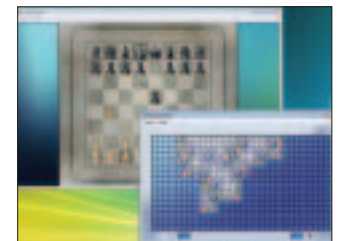
Basically, RSS feeds allow Internet Explorer to automatically download headlines from specific sites and sources, displaying them on one easily accessible page. Rather than having to read through every story to find something you're interested in, simply browse through the headlines and click one to read the full story. In our workshop on, we show you how to subscribe to RSS feeds and how to set up your desktop Sidebar so you always have the latest headlines at your fingertips.

Clever little tricks

Some of Vista's features are hidden because they're meant to be. Sync Center, for example, is an extremely useful utility, but is only intended to make itself known to those who want to synchronise compatible portable devices — MP3 players, PDAs and mobile phones, for example. Using Sync Center, it's possible to automatically synchronise data stored on a media device or storage card with your Windows Media Player Library. If you're working with Vista Ultimate, the tools have even more uses. Synchronisation can be set up between a local and a network folder, so if you regularly work with the same files from several computers, it's easy to keep all copies in sync so you're always working with the most recently edited version.



Windows Media Player can use Sync Center to ensure your latest music files are copied to your media player



Using Vista is not all about work — there's also plenty of fun to be had with a selection of games